Wacky Races Portfolio Project
Dan Waxman
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Skills Illustrated

- Data Analysis- Descriptive analytics, scatterplots
- Data Collection
- Data Processing- Adjusting for missing data
- Data Storytelling
- Google Sheets- calculations from adjusted and raw data to separate sheets.
    - Average, CountIF. Max, Median, Min

Context

Wacky Races is a television show from 1968. I enjoyed watching this show when I was younger and now, as I am a little bit older, as I am studying data analytics, I wanted to know, once and for all, who really was the ultimate racer?

To research this question, I am looking into the following information:

- Number of podium counts a racer places in the top 3 and how that equates to a percentage out of the 34 races
- Descriptive statistics using adjusted data accounting for missing information

I'll also be exploring if there is a relationship between some variables:

- Does having flight capability yield a higher place in the race?
- Does having more people in a car yield a higher place in the race?

The Wacky Racers

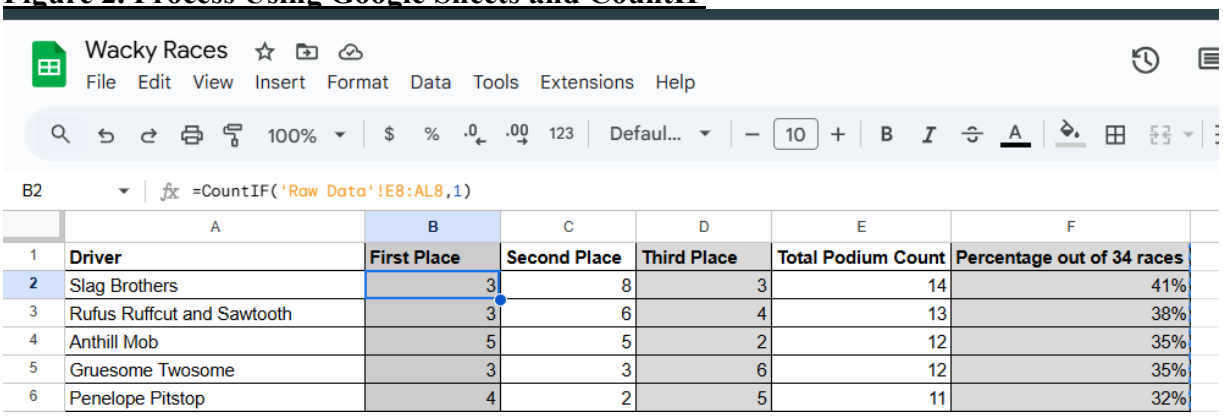
Photo Credit:
https://www.reddit.com/r/coolguides/comments/qr6e0c/wacky_races_1968_cars_and_drivers/

Figure 1. Compilation of Placings and Percentages by Racers

Racer	First Place	Second Place	Third Place	Total Podium Count	Percentage out of 34 races
Slag Brothers	3	8	3	14	41%
Rufus Ruffcut and Sawtooth	3	6	4	13	38%
Anthill Mob	5	5	2	12	35%
Gruesome Twosome	3	3	6	12	35%
Penelope Pitstop	4	2	5	11	32%
Pat Pending	3	2	5	10	29%
Red Max	3	4	3	10	29%
Luke and Blubber Bear	4	1	4	9	26%
Peter Perfect	4	2	2	8	24%
Sergeant Blast and Private Meekley	2	1	0	3	9%
Dick Dastardly and Muttley	0	0	0	0	0%

Figure 1 shows the compilation of results as sorted by racer. The right column shows their percentage won out of 34 races, respectively.

Figure 2. Process Using Google Sheets and CountIF



	A	B	C	D	E	F
1	Driver	First Place	Second Place	Third Place	Total Podium Count	Percentage out of 34 races
2	Slag Brothers	3	8	3	14	41%
3	Rufus Ruffcut and Sawtooth	3	6	4	13	38%
4	Anthill Mob	5	5	2	12	35%
5	Gruesome Twosome	3	3	6	12	35%
6	Penelope Pitstop	4	2	5	11	32%

Figure 2 illustrates the use of the CountIF function in Google Sheets as a skill using the Raw Data spreadsheet.

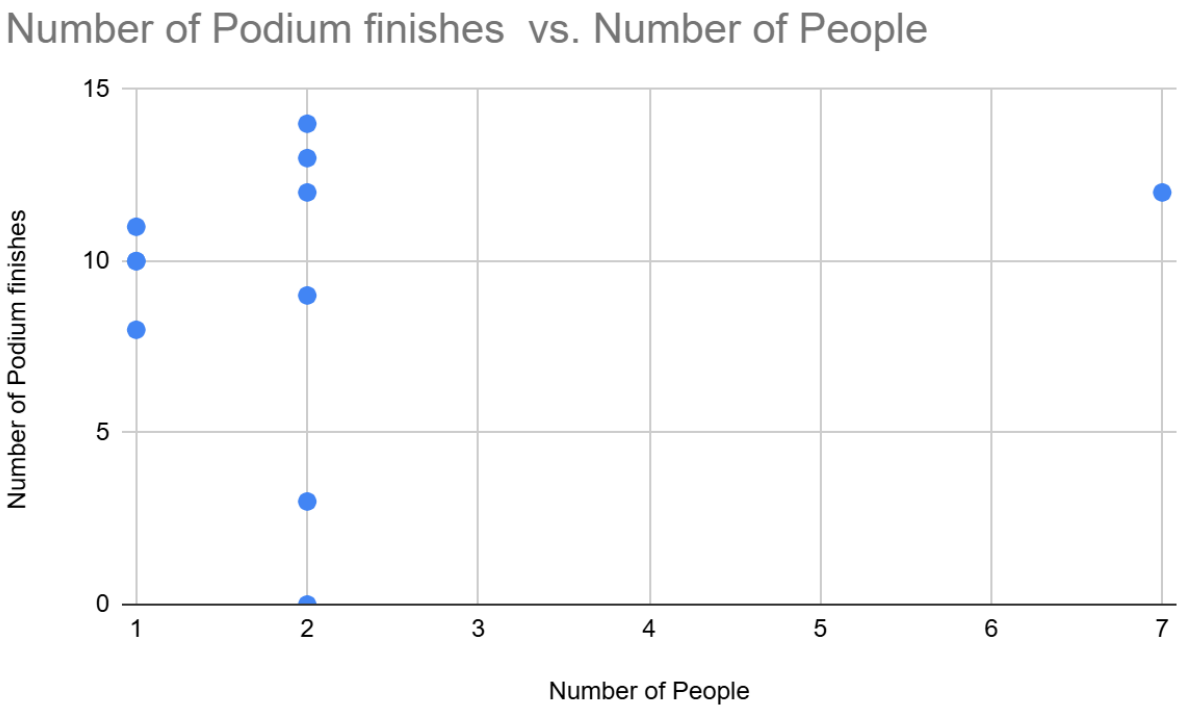
Adjusted Data

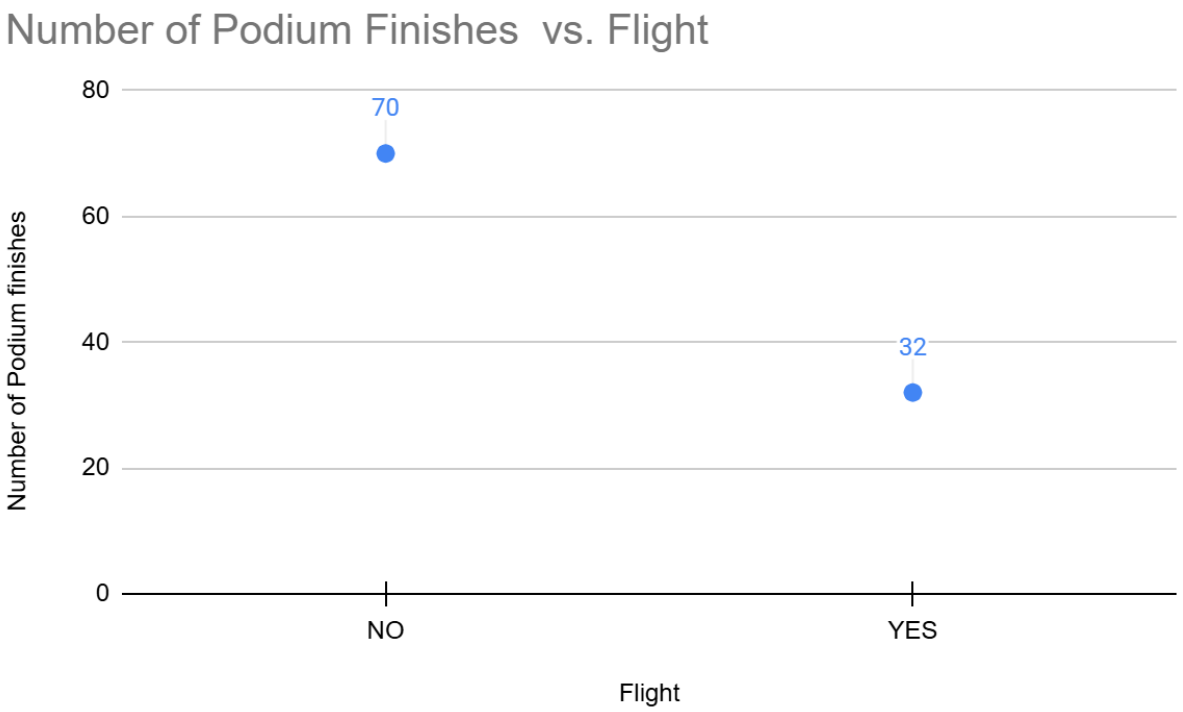
The adjusted data uses the remaining places and adding them together to find a mean that will be used for the remaining positions in the race. Dick Dastardrly and Muttley have been adjusted to finish last for all the races with the exception of the first race.

Racer	Minimum	Maximum	Median	Mean
Peter Perfect	1	9	7	5.74
Rufus Ruffcut and Sawtooth	1	10	6	5.22
Sergeant Blast and Private Meekley	1	11	7	6.46
Anthill Mob	1	10	7	5.37
Pat Pending	1	10	7	5.66
Penelope Pitstop	1	9.5	6	5.22
Slag Brothers	1	10	4	4.78
Gruesome Twosome	1	9	5	5.16
Red Max	1	10	7	5.51
Luke and Blubber Bear	1	10	7	6.12
Dick Dastardly and Muttley	4	11	11	10.79

Key Findings

- Slag Brothers are the highest ranking racer with a median of 4 and a mean of 4.78.
- Typically only 4 places are given in a race, the top 3 and Dick Dastardly in 11th place. Thus, the individual median for the remaining places gave racers a ranking of 7, which resulted in a common overall median placing of 7 for six racers. That being said the adjusted data did prove to distinguish the top two racers, Slag Brothers and Gruesome Twosome, from the rest of the group.
- Dick Dastardly and Muttley rank the worst racer with never getting higher than 4th and consistently getting last place.





Key Points:

- There doesn't seem to be a clear relationship between podium finishes and the number of people as the results are in the high range for 1,2, and 7. The results are at the lowest range for 2 because it is Dick Dastardly and Muttley who always get last place.
- While there are more podium finishes with racers without flight capabilities, this factor can not be counted as a causation because there are several more racers that do not have flight capabilities over those that are able to fly.
- Four racers have flying ability: Pat Pending, Gruesome Twosome, Red Max, and Dick Dastardly. While Gruesome Twosome placed 2nd in the adjusted data results, Pat Pending placed 4th, Red Max 5th, and Dick Dastardly 11th. Granted, flight is a nice plus to have and certainly was a benefit for the Gruesome Twosome, other racers without flight beat racers that have flight. Thus, it can be inferred that flight capability is not a determining characteristic for winning a race.